

Board 1

West Deals

None Vul

♠ Q J 9 2

♥ J 8

♦ 6 5 3 2

♣ 6 4 2

♠ A 10 8

♥ A 10 9

♦ K Q 10 8

♣ K 9 7



♠ 6 5 4

♥ K 6 5 4 3

♦ A 7

♣ A 5 3

♠ K 7 3

♥ Q 7 2

♦ J 9 4

♣ Q J 10 8

West

Pass

Pass

All Pass

3NT by North

North

1NT

3NT

East

Pass

South

2NT

NORTH has an mid-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 16 points.

SOUTH has 9 points. He bids 2NT, asking NORTH to pass if she has 15 or bid 3NT if she has 17.

But NORTH has 16 points, which leaves her with no clear choice. In this case she must decide whether her hand is a "good" 16 points or a "poor" 16 points. Since her supporting cards are mostly 10's, 9's and 8's she figures it as "good" and bids 3NT.

Board 2

South Deals

None Vul

♠ A 5 4
♥ Q J 3
♦ J 6 3 2
♣ 10 9 8

♠ 10 9 6 2

♥ K 7 5

♦ 9 5 4

♣ K Q 6



♠ 8 7 3

♥ 10 9 8 6 2

♦ A 7

♣ 5 4 2

♠ K Q J

♥ A 4

♦ K Q 10 8

♣ A J 7 3

SOUTH has 20 points and 4-4-3-2 distribution, so he opens 2NT.

NORTH has 8 points. She adds SOUTH's 20 or 21 for a total of 28 or 29, enough for game but nowhere close to the slam requirement. So she bids 3NT and SOUTH passes.

*West**North**East**South*

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by South

Board 3

West Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 7 6 5
♥ 10 7 6 2
♦ 10
♣ A 10 6 5

♠ K Q 4

♥ Q 9 5

♦ K Q 6 2

♣ K 8 3



♠ J 3 2

♥ A 8 4

♦ 9 8 7 4 3

♣ 9 4

♠ A 10 8

♥ K J 3

♦ A J 5

♣ Q J 7 2

West

Pass

All Pass

4NT by North

North

1NT

East

Pass

South

4NT

NORTH has a low-range 1NT opener; a balanced hand with 15 points.

SOUTH has 16 points; he figures the partnership holds either 31, 32 or 33. Obviously he wants to at least reach game, but if NORTH holds 17 points he wants to reach slam.

SOUTH bids 4NT. Since this is more than game it should be clear to NORTH that he is asking her to bid 6NT if she is at the top of her range. It is clear to NORTH, but with just 15 points she passes.

Board 4

South Deals
None Vul

♠ K 3 2
♥ J 10 9 3 2
♦ 8
♣ Q J 6 3

♠ 10 8 4
♥ Q 7 6
♦ K J 3
♣ K 10 5 2



♠ J 9 7 6
♥ A 4
♦ A 9 5 4 2
♣ 8 4

♠ A Q 5
♥ K 8 5
♦ Q 10 7 6
♣ A 9 7

SOUTH has a minimum 1NT opening hand - balanced distribution with 15 points.

NORTH has 9 points, which is not enough to bid game, but is worth making an invitational bid. So she says 2NT.

Since SOUTH is minimum he declines the invitation by passing.

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2NT		
All Pass			
2NT by South			